Anupam Chugh

Product-minded engineer · app builder · writer

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ABOUT

The bio below was tailor-made by my half-baked agents, burning tokens at my own startup.

I build apps, then write about what I learn. My work has taken me from delivery apps and crop cameras to managing engineers, writers and editors. I have managed engineers and engineered managers. At Alcor, I have been building an on-device AI startup: a chain of apps designed to hand work to each other.

EXPERIENCE

Independent product builder · Alcor

2024–present

- Build Apple apps from idea through release. Alcor became the name of the independent on-device AI startup in 2026. Its direction: a chain of apps that hand useful work to each other, with people choosing what gets shared. The business is now shutting down.
- Explore on-device AI, vision and agent-assisted workflows across planning, reading, music and personal tools. Released apps and prototypes are described separately in the portfolio.
- Started Glint and TradeShot mainly for myself: customizable tools for exploring markets and practicing more deliberate trading, with the aim of helping people avoid gambling-like habits.

Managing Engineers, Writers, and Editors · Better Programming

2021–2023

- Led editorial work at Better Programming (owned and run by Medium; placed on hiatus in 2023), mentoring engineers and writers as they shaped technical ideas into stories. Managed contributor and editorial workflows with a small team of editors.
- Built MediumRSS to discover writers through topic feeds, worked with Medium on curation and distribution, and started Coffee Bytes to put other writers' work in front of readers. The publication reached 4,600 authors and 151 million views over its lifetime.

Mobile Developer · Aged Care Decisions

2020–2021

- Worked on a shared iOS and Android application that different teams could adapt to their needs.

Android Team Lead & iOS Developer · Agricx

2018–2019

- Led and mentored the Android team, coordinating with web and machine-learning teams. Built the first iOS crop-inspection app using OpenCV and AVFoundation; worked on camera-based grading and ArUco marker detection.

Lead Android Developer · MOBEY

2015–2017

- Built customer and driver apps for an on-demand delivery service and contributed to the iOS redesign. Worked across the journey from placing an order to delivery.

Android Developer & Writer · JournalDev

2015–2019

- Built the Android app and wrote tutorials as I learned. Explaining code was a useful way to find the gaps in my own understanding.

SKILLS & EDUCATION

Swift · SwiftUI · iOS · macOS · Android · Vision · Core ML · AVFoundation · OpenCV · product discovery · prototyping · editorial leadership · mentoring · cross-functional collaboration

B.E. Computer Science · BITS Pilani · 2011–2015

Selected work & the connections

A selection of apps, ideas and experiments. See the full work gallery for more. The handoffs are a direction; individual integrations need their own verification.

APPS THAT LISTEN, SEE AND REMEMBER

Breakline & Wearover · movement and style

App and work in testing

Built Breakline to explore surf movement from video; developing gym set analysis and a humanoid robot that replays a person's movement from video. Gym and robot replay are in testing. Wearover explores styling a photo through prompts and taps. Breakline · Wearover

Checkmate Academy, Quorion & Flickpot · play

Apps

Chess lessons and puzzles, a social-deduction host for game nights, and a coin-flick game that reveals market charts. Checkmate · Quorion · Flickpot

Landfall & DocPolish · work and documents

App and work in development

Landfall explores career stories and résumés; DocPolish cleans document scans. A résumé-scan handoff is planned. Landfall · DocPolish

Rifflet · music lessons

App

Turn a hummed or tapped tune into a lesson for piano, guitar or ukulele. The studio's proposed connection to Mirror Hand explores what a recorded piano take could give a robot hand. Rifflet →

EchoHunt · music discovery

App

Explore why a song showed up and ask questions about it. A music-discovery companion to the studio's listening and learning experiments. EchoHunt →

Mirror Hand · motion and replay

In development

Explore hand tracking and a 3D hand that can replay recorded motion. Related hand-sign and music handoffs are under development, not a claim of a released cross-app flow. Mirror Hand →

Feedloom & Pastport · reading and memory

Apps and experiments

Feedloom keeps links and feeds together; Pastport explores finding things you previously viewed. The planned connection lets saved links meet personal history, with privacy and permissions made explicit. Feedloom · Pastport

TOOLS AND AGENT EXPERIMENTS

Meami Stays · direct booking

Live website

Built a direct-booking experience for my landlord's stays, with an assistant flow designed to check availability, quote a stay and hand the guest a booking link. The guest remains in control of booking and payment. Meami Stays → · Project story

MacItWork · Macs working together

Independent project

The vision is Macs talking and working together using their skills. The narrower starting point is approved work between paired Macs, with receipts; broader agent handoffs are planned. MacItWork →

Batmobile · Alfred clipboard research

Local prototype

Explore a read-only adapter that finds GitHub repository references in Alfred clipboard history while keeping raw clipboard content local. It is a private prototype.

ChughGPT & creative workflows

Experiments

Explore assistants for personal blog, social and media workflows, including connected tools and reviewable handoffs. Separate experiments from released capabilities.

WRITING AND COMMUNITY

I write to teach, question and occasionally make fun of the industry. Read iOSDevie, The Big Tech, Humor Bytes and my blog. iowncode shares Apple-platform examples with developers.